

Lifestyle & Community Dossier: McMenamins Anderson School, Bothell, WA

McMenamins Anderson School at 18607 Bothell Way NE ([Visit Seattle](#)) sits at the epicenter of one of the Puget Sound's most ambitious downtown transformations. **This converted 1931 Art Deco schoolhouse — now a 72-room hotel, brewery, and entertainment campus** ([Visit Seattle](#)) — anchors a walkable, rapidly urbanizing neighborhood that Seattle Met crowned its **2025 Culinary Suburb of the Year**. With a Walk Score of 86, ([walkscore](#)) a full-service grocery steps away, a pedestrianized Main Street lined with independent restaurants and shops, and the Burke-Gilman Trail threading along the Sammamish River just a five-minute walk south, this address offers a rare suburban-urban hybrid. The neighborhood's trajectory is sharply upward: hundreds of new apartments, a rerouted state highway, and Sound Transit's Stride BRT line (groundbreaking February 2026, opening ~2028) ([Sound Transit](#)) are reshaping Bothell from a sleepy bedroom community into a genuine destination.

1. Executive summary: the lifestyle scorecard

Category	Score (1-10)	Rationale
Walkability & Errands	8	Walk Score 86. QFC grocery/pharmacy within 3 min. Independent bookstore, retail, and services all under 10 min on foot. Only one full grocery within 0.75 mi keeps this from a 9.
Social & Entertainment	9	McMenamins alone has a movie theater, four bars/pubs, a pool, and live music. Add Main Street's Krō Bär speakeasy, Zulu's Board Game Café, Northshore Performing Arts Center, and a packed summer concert series.
Family & Education	8	Northshore School District rated A+ (Niche). Bothell High scores 9/10 on GreatSchools and sits 0.4 mi away. Park at Bothell Landing has playgrounds, an amphitheater, and kayak access. UW Bothell and Cascadia College are within 2 mi.
Transportation & Commute	7	Transit Score 51 today, but 7+ bus routes within 0.1-0.3 mi, I-405 access in 1 mi, and Stride S3 BRT arriving ~2028 will deliver 10-15 min frequency to Link Light Rail. Bike Score 72 thanks to Burke-Gilman Trail. Rush-hour congestion on SR-522 is the main drawback.

Overall Neighborhood Vibe: A formerly quiet suburb that now hums with craft breweries, farm-to-table restaurants, and a pedestrianized Main Street — all within earshot of the Sammamish River — making it a "Goldilocks" neighborhood for families and professionals who want urban amenities without leaving the trees behind.

2. Detailed points of interest within a 15-minute walk

Food & Drink

Top 5 Cafés and Coffee Shops

Name	Vibe / Description	Walk Time
Caffè Ladro (18610 Bothell Way NE)	Seattle-born roaster (Yelp) with drive-thru, in-house bakery, and spacious seating. Directly across the street from McMenamins.	~2 min
Daily Grind Bothell (18333 Bothell Way NE)	Family-owned, zero-waste café with Turkish-influenced pastries, baklava, and seasonal specialty drinks.	~5 min
T55 Pâtisserie (18223 Bothell Way NE)	Award-winning Southeast Asian–French fusion bakery (durian choux, black sesame raspberry). Expect lines.	~6 min
Alexa's Café (10115 Main St)	Beloved since 1995 in a 1927 brick building; (Alexascafe) famous for enormous all-day breakfasts and "the best biscuits and gravy."	~8 min
The Cottage (10029 NE 183rd St)	All-day café by morning, farm-to-table bistro and craft cocktail bar by night. (Begin at Bothell) Live music Fri–Sat.	~7 min

Top 5 Restaurants by Cuisine

Name	Cuisine	Vibe	Walk Time
Amaro Bistro (18333 Bothell Way NE)	Italian	Candlelit trattoria from the creators of Pike Place's Il Bistro; handmade pasta, glass-walled wine cellar.	~5 min
Agave Cocina & Tequila (18505 Bothell Way NE)	Contemporary Mexican	Fresh, locally sourced; one of the Northwest's largest sipping-tequila selections. Opened 2025.	~3 min
Bay Leaf Bar & Grill (18505 Bothell Way NE)	Indian / Mediterranean	Family-owned; butter chicken, tikka kababs, hummus, and craft cocktails in an intimate setting. Bayleafbarandgrill	~3 min
Side Hustle Local (18117 Bothell Way NE)	European Fusion	Speakeasy-inspired brewpub (their own Original Gangster Brewery); European skilletts, focaccia pizzas. Opened 2025. Begin at Bothell	~7 min
Beardslee Public House (19116 Beardslee Blvd)	Pacific NW Brewpub	On-site 10-barrel brewery, scratch-casual farm-to-table menu, weekend brunch.	~10 min

Top 3 Bars and Pubs

Name	Vibe	Walk Time
Krō Bär (10116 Main St)	Upscale speakeasy in a restored early-1900s building; 16-ft tin ceilings, ~500 spirits, bespoke cocktails. Reservations recommended.	~8 min
The Bine Beer & Food (10127 Main St)	Community craft-beer taproom and bottle shop; 20+ rotating taps, dog-friendly beer garden, Food Truck Fridays.	~8 min
The Bison on Main (10111 Main St)	Casual pub specializing in 100% bison burgers and house-smoked brisket; pet-friendly patio.	~8 min

Note: McMenamins itself adds four distinct on-site bars — Tavern on the Square, The Woodshop [Begin at Bothell](#) (game room/pub), [citybop](#) Nui Nui (tiki bar overlooking the saltwater pool), [citybop](#) and The Shed (whiskey speakeasy).

Recreation & Lifestyle

Parks & Green Spaces

Name	Key Features	Walk Time
Park at Bothell Landing (9919 NE 180th St)	6-acre (Expedia) crown jewel: playground, amphitheater for summer concerts, hand-carry boat launch, (Tripadvisor) historic Beckstrom Cabin (1884), (Weebly) gazebo, pop-up dog park.	~5 min
Sammamish River Trail / Burke-Gilman Trail	Paved regional multi-use trail running 30+ mi from Seattle's Ballard to Redmond's Marymoor Park. (King County) Flat, scenic, ideal for cycling and running.	~5-7 min to trailhead
Bothell City Hall Civic Plaza	Modern civic plaza with landscaping, communal seating, and public gathering space adjacent to City Hall.	~5 min
Centennial Park	Pocket park with restrooms and green space in the downtown core.	~8 min

Fitness & Gyms

Name	Type	Walk Time
The Fitness Compound (10700 Woodinville Dr)	24/7 family-owned gym; circuit training, personal training, saunas with red-light therapy. 4.9 stars on Yelp.	~12 min
Cut + Flow Studio	XFormer strength training + yoga. Slow flow, vinyasa, and machine-based classes.	~11 min
McMenamins North Shore Lagoon	112-ft saltwater soaking pool (free for Bothell residents with ID); (Begin at Bothell) originally the 1972 Northshore Pool where Olympic synchronized swimmers trained.	On-site

Entertainment Venues

Name	Type	Walk Time
McMenamins Anderson School Theater Bar	First-run movies in the old gymnasium; rocker seats, food and drink service during screenings. Begin at Bothell	On-site
Zulu's Board Game Café (10234 Main St)	Board game restaurant with hundreds of demo games, full kitchen, beer, and wine. Separate event center for RPGs and miniature wargaming.	~7 min
Northshore Performing Arts Center (18125 92nd Ave NE)	595-seat theater hosting drama, concerts, dance, and comedy on the Bothell High School campus. Begin at Bothell	~14 min
Summer Nights in Bothell (seasonal)	Free Friday evening concert series July–August at Park at Bothell Landing with food trucks and family activities. Begin at Bothell	~5 min

Community & Civic

Public Libraries

The **Bothell Library** (King County Library System, 18215 98th Ave NE) [Kids Out and About Seattle](#) is about a **6–8 minute walk** west. It offers meeting and study rooms, Wi-Fi, public computers, and a full print/scan/fax station. [King County Library System](#) Hours: Mon & Thu–Fri 10 am–6 pm; Tue–Wed 12–8 pm; Sat–Sun 11 am–6 pm. [Yelp](#)

Community Centers

Bothell City Hall & Civic Center (18415 101st Ave NE) is a **4–6 minute walk** south. The modern facility includes a Town Hall/Council Chambers, Community Meeting Hall, City Hall Gallery for rotating art exhibitions, and free underground parking (6 am–midnight).

Notable Landmarks and Cultural Sites

McMenamins Anderson School itself is the neighborhood's signature landmark [425 Magazine](#) — a **70,000-square-foot, 5-acre Art Deco campus** that was Bothell's first junior high, built in 1931 [Wikipedia +2](#) by architect Earl Wilson Morrison. The **Bothell Historical Museum** at Park at Bothell Landing (5 min walk) occupies three preserved structures: the 1893 Hannan House, the 1884 Beckstrom Cabin (Bothell's first settler family), and an 1880s one-room schoolhouse. [Weebly](#) The museum also co-hosts "History Pubs" inside McMenamins' Haynes Hall. [Bothellhistoricalmuseum](#) Downtown Bothell features a self-guided **Public Art Walking Tour** and the

Pop Shops on Main — seven whimsical micro-retail buildings incubating minority- and women-owned businesses, [Begin at Bothell](#) a City of Bothell initiative launched in 2021.

Daily Errands & Retail

Grocery Stores

Name	Type	Walk Time
QFC (18921 Bothell Way NE)	Full-service Kroger-family supermarket with pharmacy, deli, bakery, and floral. Yellow Pages Open 5 am–1 am. Waze	~4 min

QFC is the only full-service grocery within 0.75 miles. The nearest Safeway is ~1.5 mi; Trader Joe's and PCC Community Markets are in Canyon Park (~3 mi).

Pharmacies

Name	Walk Time
QFC Pharmacy (18921 Bothell Way NE)	~4 min
Healthpoint Bothell Pharmacy (10414 Beardslee Blvd) — community health center, accepts Medicaid Healthgrades	~11 min

Key Retail

Name	Type	Walk Time
Wanderlust Book Lounge (10202 NE 185th St)	Independent bookstore with book clubs, writer's workshops, and live music Begin at Bothell	~5 min
Pop Shops on Main	Rotating micro-retail incubator for local small businesses Begin at Bothell	~3 min
First and Main Design Market	Home furnishings and interior design studio	~6 min
Bothell Ski & Bike	Ski and bike sales, rentals, and service	~7 min
CoCapsules	Fashion boutique with trending and timeless clothing	~6 min

3. Educational profile

This address is served by the **Northshore School District**, rated **A+** by Niche [Niche](#) and ranked in the top 5% of Washington's 247 districts.

Zoned Schools (K-12 Feeder Pattern)

School	Type	Grades	GreatSchools Rating	Distance
Westhill Elementary	Public	PK, K-5	6/10	~0.6 mi
Northshore Middle School	Public	6-8	8/10	~1.7 mi
Bothell High School	Public	9-12	9/10	~0.4 mi

Bothell High boasts a **97% graduation rate**, average SAT of **1,300**, and an average ACT of **29**.

[Homes.com](#) Northshore Middle is ranked the **#35 public middle school in Washington** by Niche.

[Niche](#)

Nearby Private Schools

School	Grades	Niche Grade	Distance
St. Brendan Catholic School	PK-8	B+	~1.0 mi
Heritage Christian Academy	PK-10	A	~1.1 mi
Cedar Park Christian Schools	PK-12	B+	~1.7 mi
Evergreen Academy Elementary	K-5	A	~1.9 mi

Higher education is also close: the **University of Washington Bothell** and **Cascadia College** ([Bothellkenmorechamber](#)) share a campus roughly 1.5 miles northeast, making this area a draw for faculty, staff, and continuing-education students.

4. Transportation & commute profile

Public transit access

The nearest bus stop is **Bothell Way NE & NE 180th St**, just **0.1 miles** from the front door, serving three agencies and seven-plus routes:

- **Sound Transit Express 522** — the primary regional commuter route connecting Woodinville to Roosevelt Station (Link Light Rail) in Seattle. ([GreaterSound](#)) Heavy weekday frequency.
- **Sound Transit Express 535** — I-405 express from Lynnwood to Bellevue, stopping at Bothell Park & Ride (~0.4 mi east, 220 spaces). ([GreaterSound](#))
- **King County Metro 372** — all-day service ([Moovit](#)) from Lake City to UW Bothell, running ~4 am to ~1:30 am.
- **King County Metro 230/239** — local Bothell Way NE corridor service.
- **Community Transit 106/120/121** — connections to Lynnwood City Center Station (Link Light Rail), UW Bothell, and Mariner Park & Ride. ([Pantograph](#))

Coming in ~2028: Stride S3 Bus Rapid Transit. Sound Transit broke ground in **February 2026** on this transformative line ([The Urbanist](#)) ([Sound Transit](#)) — **15 battery-electric articulated buses running every 10–15 minutes**, ([Sound Transit](#)) 19 hours a day, along SR-522 from Bothell to Shoreline South/148th Station ([Sound Transit](#)) (Link Light Rail). ([Sound Transit](#)) A station will sit approximately **0.1 mi** from McMenamins. Travel time to Link Light Rail will drop from up to 59 minutes to roughly **35 minutes**. ([Sound Transit](#)) A new **Bothell/Woodinville Transit Center** at the I-

405/SR-522 interchange will link S3 with the Stride S2 line (Sound Transit) (I-405 BRT, Lynnwood to Bellevue, opening ~2029). (Sound Transit)

Major road access

McMenamins sits directly on **SR-522 (Bothell Way NE)**, the primary east-west arterial along Lake Washington's north shore. **I-405 is ~1 mile east** (2–3 min drive off-peak) via the SR-522 interchange, which is currently under major reconstruction (completion ~2028) adding express toll lanes and direct-access ramps. (WSDOT) I-5 is reachable via I-405 north (~7 mi to Lynnwood) or SR-522 west (~10 mi through Lake Forest Park). **Mean commute time for Bothell residents is 27.7 minutes**, (Census Reporter) though peak-hour congestion on SR-522 can push a 20-minute off-peak drive to Seattle or Bellevue past 45–60 minutes. (GreaterSound)

Bikeability: 72/100 — Very Bikeable

The **Burke-Gilman Trail / Sammamish River Trail** is the star asset, accessible **0.3 miles south** at Bothell Landing. This flat, paved, 30-mile regional trail connects all the way to Ballard in Seattle (west) and Marymoor Park in Redmond (east), (King County) making bike commuting viable for trips to UW Seattle (~15 mi), Woodinville, or Kirkland. On-street bike infrastructure is limited (Walk Score) — SR-522 is not bike-friendly, and dedicated lanes on surface streets remain sparse — but the trail system more than compensates for recreational and commute cycling.

5. Neighborhood character & demographics

A suburb reinventing itself around an Art Deco landmark

The immediate area around McMenamins Anderson School is defined by a striking **collision of old and new**. The 1931 Art Deco schoolhouse, with its distinctive flourishes and large original windows, (Mcmenamins) sits alongside five- and six-story mixed-use apartment buildings that didn't exist a decade ago. Main Street, one block south, retains charming early-1900s brick-and-mortar storefronts (The Urbanist) — the Mohn Building (now Krō Bär) dates to Bothell's founding era — but has been pedestrianized and lined with streetscape upgrades. The broader residential fabric is a patchwork of **Craftsman bungalows, mid-century ramblers, and contemporary townhome complexes**, (Homes.com) with newer Craftsman-inspired homes featuring stone finishes filling in around the periphery.

Key demographic indicators

Indicator	Value
Population	~50,670 (2025 est.)

Indicator	Value
Median age	38.0 years (Washington Demographics)
Median household income	\$140,427 — roughly 1.7× the national median (Census Reporter)
Per capita income	\$72,775 (Census Reporter)
Population density	~3,600–4,300/sq mi
Bachelor's degree or higher	59.8% of adults 25+ (Census Reporter)
Homeownership rate	64.9%
Median home sale price	~\$945,000 (Feb 2026)
Average apartment rent	~\$2,270/month
Racial composition	60% White, 18% Asian, 10% Hispanic/Latino, (Washington Demographics) 10% two or more races

Bothell's population has surged **~70% since 2000**, (Neilsberg) with a 40% jump in the last decade alone. The city straddles King and Snohomish Counties, (Community Transit) and its tech-corridor employers (AGC Biologics, Seagen, FUJIFILM Sonosite) plus proximity to Eastside and Seattle tech campuses draw a heavily **educated, affluent, professionally employed population**. The top job categories are computer/mathematical and management occupations. (Data USA) Downtown specifically is attracting younger couples and singles into new mixed-use developments, (Homes.com) while outer neighborhoods remain strongly family-oriented.

McMenamins Anderson School as community anchor

The property is far more than a hotel. Its **70,000-square-foot, 5-acre campus** functions as Bothell's de facto town square (Begin at Bothell) — a place where locals swim in a pool where Olympic athletes once trained, (mcmenamins) catch first-run movies in a converted gymnasium, browse a kitchen garden that feeds the on-site restaurants, (Begin at Bothell) and attend History Pub lectures co-hosted with the Bothell Historical Museum. The McMenamin brothers commissioned staff historians to interview former students before opening (425 Magazine) in 2015, and the halls are lined with portraits of past teachers and stained-glass pieces that preserve institutional memory. (425 Magazine) Every one of the 72 guest rooms is named for someone connected to the school's history or the Bothell community — from U.S. Senator Patty Murray to local R&B singer Bernadette Bascom. (Wikipedia) The City of Bothell identified the property as "**a key part of the city's long-term redevelopment plan**," (McMenamins) and major adjacent

developments like The Junction (130 apartments, 10,000 sq ft retail) explicitly market their proximity to it. [Mspgroupllc](#)

6. Narrative synthesis: a day in the life

You wake up in a neighborhood that doesn't quite feel suburban anymore. Outside, SR-522 carries its morning current of commuters, but you're walking — four minutes to QFC for milk and coffee beans, then a detour through the civic plaza where a few early joggers nod hello. The Bothell Library isn't open yet, but the book-return slot takes back your overdue novel.

By mid-morning you're at Caffè Ladro, directly across from the old brick schoolhouse where McMenamins' Tavern on the Square is already prepping lunch. The espresso is good. The Wi-Fi is fast. Through the window you can see a family loading a kayak onto the Sammamish River at Bothell Landing, and beyond the park, a cyclist disappears down the Burke-Gilman Trail headed toward Seattle — a flat, paved, 15-mile ride to the University of Washington if that's your commute.

Lunch options are almost absurdly good for a town that, a decade ago, had very few. T55 Pâtisserie has a line out the door for durian choux pastry. [Begin at Bothell](#) Amaro Bistro, from the same family behind Seattle's legendary Il Bistro, does a carbonara that holds its own against anything on Capitol Hill. Agave Cocina pours tequila flights. Bay Leaf serves butter chicken next door. Seattle Met didn't name Bothell its Culinary Suburb of the Year for nothing.

After school lets out at Bothell High — a 9/10-rated campus just two blocks west — teenagers drift toward Zulu's Board Game Café on Main Street while parents push strollers through the Pop Shops, the whimsical micro-retail pods where a new small business rotates in every year. The Northshore School District's [SchoolDigger](#) A+ rating [GreatSchools](#) is a quiet magnet; families move here for Bothell High's **97% graduation rate** [Homes.com](#) and stay for the walkability they didn't expect from the suburbs.

The afternoon belongs to the trail. The Sammamish River Trail is a five-minute walk from your front door and carries you into a green corridor of wetlands and wildlife that feels disconnected from the six-story apartment buildings rising behind you. You pass the Bothell Historical Museum's 1884 log cabin, [Weebly](#) wave at someone walking their dog through the pop-up dog park, and loop back through downtown.

Evening settles in at McMenamins. You catch a movie in the old gymnasium, beer in hand, feet up in a rocker seat. Or you cross the courtyard to Nui Nui, the tiki bar overlooking the saltwater pool, and order something with rum while kids splash below. [Begin at Bothell](#) On Fridays in summer, the amphitheater at Bothell Landing fills with families sprawled on blankets, food trucks lining the path, and a local band playing until dusk fades into the Douglas firs.

[Begin at Bothell](#)

The commute question — always the commute question — is the honest friction point. SR-522 crawls during rush hour, [GreaterSound](#) and a 20-minute off-peak drive to Bellevue can triple. But the **Sound Transit 522 express** already puts you at Roosevelt Station and Link Light Rail, and by 2028, Stride S3's battery-electric buses will run every 10 minutes on a dedicated busway, [Sound Transit](#) cutting travel time to the light rail network to roughly 35 minutes. [Sound Transit](#) The I-405/SR-522 interchange reconstruction, painful now, will yield express toll lanes and direct-access ramps. [Washington State Department of Transportation](#) The infrastructure is catching up to the ambition.

What makes this address work — for a young couple in a new mixed-use apartment, for a family in a nearby Craftsman, for someone launching a business on Main Street — is the convergence. A historic landmark that functions as a living room for the entire community. A **\$140,000 median household income** that signals economic stability. A downtown that was literally redesigned from scratch, [Bothell WA](#) with the highway moved and the main street handed back to pedestrians. Bothell is no longer the place you drive through on the way to somewhere else. Increasingly, it's the place you stop.